

Q1. What do you understand from the word, "Communication"? Why is effective communication vital in today's world?

Ans. Researchers and analysts have come up with various definitions for the word "Communication" but essentially it means transfer of ideas, plans, information, feelings and emotions from one person to another. The most common medium used to communicate is language.

The importance of effective communication skills can be gauged from the fact that professionals spend three-fourths of their working time in communicating ideas, making plans, building teams and executing the plans, making presentations, conveying work related matters and several other official matters. In this ever-demanding professional world, therefore incumbents are expected to be articulate, expressive and communicative.

Q2. Counselling, Instructing, giving orders, persuasion are objectives of communication. Discuss

Ans. Communication to persuade is a form of communication that focuses on the receiver and not the message. The communicator basically seeks to persuade or convince the reader. Sometimes the communicator may both inform and persuade the reader at the same time. Sales letters, advertisements, announcements, journalistic writings, not only provide information but also try to convince the reader about the utility or authenticity of their information.

Eg:- Presenting a report to a committee; you may just be passing on recorded information and let it do its job. On the other hand, sometimes the goal of communication is to persuade the receiver

Personal advice or counselling is also provided to an employee by superiors, colleagues or experts. Counselling helps an employee to sort out his personal problems (family, financial, physical etc.) which could have affected his professional performance or growth in the organization

To achieve the goals of the organisation and to facilitate smooth functioning, orders and instructions have to be communicated from the higher levels to the

lower levels of hierarchy.

An order is given by the superior to the subordinate to carry out a particular task or modify what is already done or sometimes to change the course of something which is being done.

Instructions go along with orders. Assigned tasks have to be performed so that the goals of the organisation are achieved. Subordinates are given instructions and guidelines about the tasks to be carried out.

Q3. What are barriers? How do they disrupt the communication process or create communication gap?

Ans. The communication process is often affected by the limitations of the sender as well as the receiver and the desired result is not obtained. Barriers are the unplanned interferences in the mechanics used for communication. It is also termed as 'Noise'.

In oral communication, barriers may arise if the sender is disorganised, uses irrelevant information, chooses sloppy words or has a poor voice quality. In written communication, poor message composition, wrong syntax, incorrect spellings and punctuation can lead to the entire message being misconstrued. The receiver's inattentiveness, level of understanding and intelligence, can also contribute to a communication breakdown.

Barriers to communication are of various types; they can be physical, mechanical, organisational, psychological, cultural and linguistic in nature. Whatever the type, all barriers distort the communication process and create gaps in communication.

Q4. A free flow of information ensures the success of any organization." Elaborate this statement in the light of the channels of communication in any organization.

Ans. The major role of communication in organizations is to disseminate information that further facilitate decision-making and problem-solving. Managers are expected to use adequate and effective communication to receive and transmit information that enables the organization to perform effectively.

The amount of information that large organisations have to deal with may cause information overload, but the value of information can hardly be overstated.

Information involves the transferring or receiving of data about a particular fact or situation. It may be oral, written or conveyed by using the system of signs and signals. Complete, accurate and precise information is required at the senior levels of hierarchy to plan and organize the day-to-day tasks of the organization.

Q5. Explain the entire process of communication which is cyclic in nature with a suitable diagram and appropriate examples

Ans. The sender encodes the message and sends it through a medium/channel. The medium/channel is nothing but the language used words, actions, signs, objects or a combination of these. The receiver receives the message, decodes it and acts on it.

If the message received is the same as the message sent there will be a response, if not, there has been a breakdown in communication. This may happen because of noise. Noise is any unplanned interference in the mechanics of communication.

The transmission of the receiver's response to the sender is called feedback. Feedback is essential as it is a barometer of effective communication. If you are sending a message to somebody, your communication cycle is complete only when you get a response from the recipient of your message. Otherwise, you need to resend the message. Even if a response is received, it may not be the one that was expected. But if you receive some response, it means that the message has

been communicated successfully to the other party. Hence feedback is the observation of the recipient response

A classroom is the communication environment where a teacher delivers lectures to students. The teacher's cubicle becomes the communication environment when a student approaches her in her cubicle to talk about something.

Q6. What is the importance of formal oral communication? Is it more dynamic than written communication?

Ans. a. Ability to initiate the discussion and contribute points relevant to the topic, so that the discussion reaches a valid conclusion

b. Ability to showcase leadership capabilities by guiding other members in the group to express their view points, pertinent to the topic of discussion.

c. Ability to establish team co-ordination and reach an agreeable solution or consensus.

d. Ensuring the use of correct accent, intonation, articulation, and voice modulation in addition to the right posture, gestures and eye contact.

Yes, Oral communication is dynamic in nature, so it is more vibrant when compared to written communication.

In interpersonal or face-to-face communication, non-verbal components aid oral and vibrant. communication. Since immediate feedback is possible, the process becomes more diplomatic and vibrant.

Q7. Grapevine is a formal communication flow in an organization which has both positive and negative impact on the environment. Elaborate

Ans. Gossips, hearsay, rumours, go to make up that 'Personal Communication' that is grapevine. As a result of it views, opinions and attitudes are formed which can do great harm to the organisation.

As may well be imagined the grapevine can do great harm or good to an organisation; it may cause the workers to lose their morale or to work with redoubled vigour. If the top management of an organisation is intelligent it will try to feed the grapevine with information that is accurate and which will serve as a morale booster.

Positive impact

a) Informal Relations: Grapevine communication binds the people together in an organisation. Employees freely share their joys, sorrows and other emotions at the workplace.

b) Quick Transmission: Grapevine stories spread very rapidly. If a worker has met with an accident the news will reach all the workers of the factory in a flash.

c) Promotes team spirit: As employees get the freedom to communicate outside the formal channels of communication, it enables them to form a cohesive team which benefits the organisation

d) Feedback: Grapevine is an informal way of communicating; people give their honest opinions fearlessly. Management can get true feedback about their policies and procedures and implement them in an employee friendly way.

Negative impact

a) Distortion: As grapevine mainly promotes gossips and rumours, distorted messages can demoralize the employees.

b) Lacks Credibility: Messages and information passed through grapevine communication lack credibility as people tend to distort the original message by adding their own comments and observations.

c) Lacks Responsibility: As grapevine communication is informal in nature, the communicator does not take responsibility of the message.

d) Time Waster: Grapevine communication may lead to wastage of time. People enjoy gossip sessions, and useless unauthentic information is passed on.